



Fedora India

A Collaborative *configure & make*

A sneak-peak into the Fedora Project and the India-based community around it!

For a large number of users, developers and contributors, 'Fedora' is a Linux-based operating system that provides them with access to the latest free and open source software in a stable, secure and easy-to-manage form. Fedora is both an epicentre of innovation in free and open source software (FOSS), and a community where developers and enthusiasts come together to advance FOSS.

The Fedora community includes software developers, artists, systems administrators, Web designers, translators, writers and speakers, making it the most vibrant community to be a part of.

The Indian community

There has always been a strong user base of Fedora right from the early days of Fedora Core 1. Over a period of five years in which Fedora saw a release of 10 versions, the community in India has also evolved. From being mere consumers/users of the operating system, there has been an organic transformation into a community of active participants and contributors. An increase in the number

and forms of contribution has also helped to ideate about the focus and objectives of the community in India.

As a result of the increasing number of members, there is an active set of discussion forums on the mailing list and the IRC channel. This has enabled an exponential growth in Fedora's reach, adding to the word-of-mouth growth of its users and contributors in India.

Plans

The initial momentum to participate in the Fedora Project arose from the need to localise the operating system and relevant content into Indian languages. Thus, there has always been an active Indic localisation community around Fedora, and their stellar contributions can be seen in the recent release of Fedora 10.

Thus, although Indic localisation was the primary driver, the larger goal has always been to increase the quantum and quality of contributions to the Fedora project. A set of smaller objectives has been put in place to achieve the goal. To get a quick overview, let's put the tasks into the following three categories: